The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Morndas, the 12th of Frostfall (Monday, October 12, 2026) ·
Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 12 · Price: One Septim



Gandy guards the dry boards while Maevy tries to catch the sky.

Skies o'er the Hold

59° / 52°

Rain — Flood Watch until 5 PM

Sunrise 6:28 AM · Sunset 5:54 PM

Tomorrow — Morning rain, then partly cloudy, 59/44

Overheard Last Night

A soaked traveler asked the barkeep when the rain would let up. The barkeep only shrugged: "Aye — the Watch runs till five, but the pines will believe it when they see it."

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday — *Tonight* — New Moon — *Tomorrow* — Waxing Crescent

waxing toward the full moon

12th of Frostfall = October 12

Months run one-for-one all year
Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Rain Soaks the Rim as Art, Music & Hula Fill the Week

Payson, Ariz.

PAYSON — Hail, good neighbor, and mind the puddles! Morndas has thrown open the very floodgates over the Mogollon Rim, with rain drumming the pines all day and a Flood Watch standing till five o'clock — a fine day for the mead hall, the museum shelf, and watching Gandy glare at the sky from the dry boards. The week ahead dries out and dresses up: the Payson Art League's ARToberFest fills the Mazatzal Casino Event Center Friday through Sunday, Sedona's Plein Air Festival sets up its easels across the red rocks, Camp Verde sways to Hawaiian hula, and Sunday brings a parade of costumed hounds to Tlaquepaque. By the Nine, keep your cloak handy today and your dancing shoes ready for the weekend.



The week ahead paints itself: ARToberFest in Payson, easels up across Sedona, and fall festivals under the Rim.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Pine-Strawberry**

  — Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose — 4–7 PM at THAT Brewery & Pub, 3270 N AZ-87, Pine. The community open mic returns on its every-other-Monday rhythm, hosted this season by the Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction crew, with all tips going to forest-protection work. Seasoned pickers, first-time singers, poets, and storytellers all take the little stage — or just claim a pint and a bench and let the neighbors entertain you. A warm, wood-stove sort of evening; the rain on the roof only improves it.

- **Prescott**

  — Prescott History Tour — 10 AM–noon, departing downtown Prescott. A two-hour guided walk through the old territorial capital's most storied streets, from Whiskey Row's saloons to the Victorian mansions of Nob Hill, led by guides who know every governor and ghost. Book ahead at freakyfoottours.com. A fine outing for history-curious guests — and the rain gives Whiskey Row a properly atmospheric gleam.

— Fall Break Nature Camp — Monday through Friday, 8 AM–4 PM, Highlands Center for Natural History, 1375 S Walker Rd. A fully outdoor week of hiking, games, science investigations, and journaling on Prescott National Forest trails, for ages 6–10. $250 for members, $300 for non-members. (The Seedlings half-day track for little ones is full, with a waitlist.)

— Fall Zoo Camp — Monday through Friday, 8:30 AM–3 PM, Heritage Park Zoological Sanctuary, 1403 Heritage Park Rd. Ages 6–12 get hands-on animal time, behind-the-scenes visits, wildlife games, crafts, and investigations at Prescott's hometown zoo. $250 for members, $300 for non-members. A grand week for young naturalists.

The Days Ahead

- **Tuesday, Oct. 13**

  — Trail Day Volunteer Build — 7 AM–noon, off AZ-87 just before Pine. The Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction crew calls hikers, bikers, runners, and forest-lovers to clear brush, move rock, and shape new trail that doubles as firefighter access. No experience needed and tools are provided — bring water, gloves, and sturdy boots, and RSVP to trails@psfuelreduction.org for the meeting spot. Honest work under tall pines, and the best breakfast appetite you'll earn all week.

- **Thursday, Oct. 15**

  — A Band Called Honalee — 7 PM, Payson High School Auditorium, 301 S McLane Rd. A modern folk trio channeling Peter, Paul & Mary — “Leaving on a Jet Plane,” “Blowin' in the Wind,” “Puff the Magic Dragon” — in close three-part harmony, with nods to Dylan, Joni Mitchell, and the Mamas & the Papas. Thirty-odd locals have already flagged they're going. A gentle, sing-along sort of evening for folk hearts.

  — Gary Allan with Julie Eddy — 7:30 PM, Findlay Toyota Center, 3201 N Main St, Prescott Valley. The country hitmaker behind “Man to Man” and “Every Storm (Runs Out of Rain)” brings his raspy honky-tonk show to the region's big arena. The week's biggest-ticket concert — third-party listings show seats from about $64. A proper arena night out under the Rim.

- **Friday, Oct. 16**

  — ARToberFest — Friday through Sunday, Mazatzal Casino Event Center. The Payson Art League's annual fine art and fine craft show and sale gathers the Hold's artists all in one hall, with the Payson Jazz Trio playing and an art raffle benefiting local school art programs. Come to browse or come to buy — the raffle alone is worth the trip, and the whole weekend hums.

  — 22nd Annual Sedona Plein Air Festival — Friday through Oct. 24, Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Rd, plus painting sites across Sedona and the Verde Valley. One of the West's oldest plein air festivals: dozens of master artists painting the red rocks outdoors, with free public demonstrations and paint-outs all week long. Free to watch the artists work; the grand sale closes the festival Oct. 24.

- **Saturday, Oct. 17**

  — Fest of Fall — Saturday, Posse Grounds Park, 525 Posse Ground Rd (the city lists 11 AM–5 PM). Sedona's family fall celebration: food trucks, local brews, live music, craft and nonprofit vendors, pickleball and cornhole tournaments, a kids' zone with pumpkin carving, skate jam, and photo booth. Pair it with the morning's **Pumpkin Splash** at the community pool (11 AM–1 PM, $5 — pick your pumpkin right out of the water). Free, low-waste, and made for lingering.

  — 21st Annual Ho'ike — Hula Exhibition — Doors 12:30 PM, show 1 PM, Phillip England Center for the Performing Arts, 280 Camp Lincoln Rd, Camp Verde. Authentic Hawaiian hula, music, and culture in the Verde Valley: a scholar's presentation on ancient hula instruments opens the show, followed by modern hula, a 50-50 raffle, island goods, and a silent auction of Hawaiian art. Proceeds benefit Aloha 'Aina O Hawai'i. The most transporting afternoon of the week.

- **Sunday, Oct. 18**

  — Howl-O-Ween Dog Costume Parade — 10 AM–noon (check-in 9–9:30 AM), Tlaquepaque Arts & Shopping Village, 336 SR-179, Sedona. The 6th annual parade of costumed canines, from Calle Independencia to Tlaquepaque North — $20 per dog, with proceeds to the Humane Society of Sedona. Costume contests carry $100 prizes (Doggone Cutest, Craziest Canine, and the group Leaders of the Pack), judged by the mayor-elect himself. Even dogless, it's the happiest two hours in the Verde Valley.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — draw the sconces and ready them before a single torch can burn.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue since Oct. 3 — the printers stand ready; give them their orders.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue since Oct. 10 — hang the finished torches and light the way.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Due Saturday, Oct. 17 — the Hearth's arms take shape; mount it by the front door after.

The torches languish overdue while the shield must rise by Saturday — the Hearth's doors await their guardians.



Torch sconces on the bench, the troll shield fresh with paint — the Hearth's doors await their guardians.

Word from the Payson Hold



The **Payson Town Council** holds its regular meeting on **Wednesday, Oct. 14, at 4:00 PM** in the Town Hall Council Chambers, 303 N Beeline Hwy. The agenda packet had not been posted as of Monday morning — the town posts agendas at least 24 hours ahead, so watch for it by Tuesday afternoon.

Find the meeting notice at paysonaz.gov; the town has also scheduled a live stream of the meeting on its YouTube channel.

Merchant of the Hold

Western Village · *Payson*



The gem counter at Western Village, where the dragon's-hoard glitters.

Twenty-five thousand square feet of treasure on the Beeline — antiques, fine art, and high-end jewelry, plus a glittering back wing of gems, rocks, and minerals that would make a dragon weep with envy. Native American artifacts, cowboy memorabilia, vintage books, taxidermy, and room after room of frontier curiosities. It could pass for a museum, except here you're allowed to take the exhibits home.

> *"A very nice western store. Wonderful gems and jewelry items. All genuine."* — TripAdvisor

1104 S Beeline Hwy, Payson — open daily 10 AM–5 PM, closed Tuesdays; (928) 474-3431; easy on the purse ($–$$). Good to know: pets are welcome, and there's layaway for the grand finds. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: Because no guest should leave the Rim without one good treasure-hunting morning — and this is the grandest trove in the Hold.

Tales from the Treeline

The Great Trench Rescue



Jethro plows the trench while Earl sights the slope and Henny christens the puddles.

Morndas dawned with the sky wrung out over the Rim, and Mabel (a wood elf) stood in her herb garden watching her sage drown. “Trench,” she announced, the way a general declares war. “We dig a trench, or the thyme goes swimming.”

Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) took this as a personal commission. He dropped to all fours and plowed a furrow down the middle of the garden with his whole enormous body, humming a digging song, while Earl (an elk) stood by in enormous dignity holding Mabel's plumb line in his antlers so she could sight the slope. “Left,” said Mabel. Earl leaned left. “Right.” Earl leaned right, and the plumb bob swung round and bopped him square on the nose.

Gus (a friendly orc) arrived with a tray of trench pies — “morale rations,” he rumbled softly — just as Henny (a plump red-combed chicken) declared the deepest puddle her personal pond and christened it with a splash.

By noon the garden drained sweet as a whistle. The single casualty: Jethro's trench ran a touch too true and drained Mabel's rain barrel clean through the fence boards. Jethro stared at the empty barrel, then up at the weeping sky, and said, “Well. The sky will fill it back.”

Mabel sighed like it was her job. “It had better,” she said. “It's on trench duty next.”

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Morndas be free of skeevers, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com



The Rim at dusk, keeping watch over the Holds.